

Word family: common / commonly / commonality / commonness / commonplace / commons / commoner

Base word: common

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, with several established **noun** and compound uses

Related forms:

- **common** (adj.) — 共同的; 常見的; 普通的; 一般的; 共有的
- **commonly** (adv.) — 常見地; 通常; 普遍地
- **commonality** (n.) — 共同點; 共通性
- **commonness** (n.) — 普遍性; 平凡性(較少見)
- **commonplace** (adj./n.) — 平常的; 司空見慣的事
- **commons** (n.) — 公共用地; 共有資源; 公共領域
- **commoner** (n.) — 平民; 非貴族人士
- **common-law** (adj.) — 普通法的; 某些制度中的非正式伴侶／婚姻相關
- **uncommon** (important opposite) — 不常見的; 非凡的
- **uncommonly** — 不尋常地; 格外地

Major useful extensions:

common purpose, common goal, common objective, common interest, common concern, common problem, common enemy, common cause, common ground, common bond, common identity, common language, common culture, common history, common heritage, common responsibility, common ownership, common property, common resources, common area, common room, common land, common knowledge, common sense, common courtesy, common decency, common practice, common occurrence, common mistake, common problem, common feature, common symptom, common disease, common name, common noun, common gender, common denominator, common factor, common multiple, lowest common denominator, greatest common factor/divisor, least common multiple, common fraction, common ratio, common logarithm, common stock, common shares, common market, common law, common-law system, common-law marriage/partner, common good, the commons, tragedy of the commons, House of Commons, commoner, have something in common, have a lot/little/nothing in common, in common with, share something in common, for the common good, common to, common among, common in, commonly used, commonly known as, commonly found, common-or-garden, common touch.

Meaning in this passage

Group work is most effective when contribution is transparent, communication is disciplined and leadership is strong enough to unite different personalities around a **common purpose**.

Here, **common** means:

shared by all the people in a group — 共同的; 大家共有的

A **common purpose** is a purpose that everyone is working towards together.

The team members may differ in:

- personality,
- working style,
- priorities,
- expertise,
- communication habits,

but they are united by:

one shared purpose

中文翻譯：

當每名成員的貢獻都清楚透明、溝通有紀律，而且領導層足以把不同性格的人團結在一個共同目標／共同目的之下時，團隊合作才最有效。

So here:

common purpose = 團隊所有成員共同認同並努力實現的目的

A. COMMON = SHARED BY TWO OR MORE PEOPLE

1. common = shared by several people or groups — 共同的; 共有的

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — original sentence

Strong leadership can unite different personalities around a **common purpose**.

良好的領導可以把不同性格的人團結在一個共同目的之下。

Practice 2

The departments are working towards a **common goal**.

各部門正朝着一個共同目標努力。

Practice 3

Successful teams usually share some common values.

成功的團隊通常具有一些共同價值觀。

MCQ-ready definition:

common = 由兩個或以上的人、群體或事物共同擁有、接受或追求的

2. common purpose — 共同目的

Practice 1

A **common purpose** can unite people with very different personalities.

一個共同目的可以團結性格非常不同的人。

Practice 2

Without a common purpose, teamwork can lose direction.

沒有共同目的，團隊合作可能失去方向。

3. common goal — 共同目標

Practice 1

Everyone must work towards a **common goal**.

所有人都必須朝着一個共同目標努力。

Practice 2

A common goal helps reduce internal competition.

共同目標有助減少內部競爭。

4. common objective — 共同目標

Practice 1

The two departments agreed on a **common objective**.

兩個部門就一項共同目標達成共識。

Practice 2

Different priorities can still support one common objective.

不同優先事項仍然可以服務於同一個共同目標。

MCQ-ready definition:

common objective = 多方共同認同並希望實現的具體目標

5. common interest — 共同興趣; 共同利益

This has **two closely related readings**.

A. shared interest/topic

Music is a **common interest**.

音樂是他們的共同興趣。

B. shared benefit

Both departments have a **common interest in the project's success**.
兩個部門對項目成功都有共同利益。

6. common concern — 共同關注的問題

Practice 1

Staff safety is a **common concern**.

員工安全是大家共同關注的問題。

Practice 2

The meeting focused on areas of common concern.

會議集中討論大家共同關注的事項。

7. common problem — 共同問題；普遍問題

This phrase can be ambiguous.

Shared problem:

This is a **common problem for both teams**.
這是兩個團隊共同面對的問題。

Frequent problem:

This is a **common problem in large teams**.
這是大型團隊中常見的問題。

Context decides whether **common** means:

- **shared**, or
- **frequent**.

8. common enemy — 共同敵人

Practice 1

Rival groups sometimes cooperate against a **common enemy**.

互相競爭的群體有時會為對付共同敵人而合作。

Practice 2

A common enemy can temporarily unite divided groups.

共同敵人有時可以暫時把分裂的群體團結起來。

9. common cause — 共同事業; 共同目標

Practice 1

The organisations joined together in a **common cause**.

各機構為一項共同事業而合作。

Practice 2

Shared difficulties gave the workers a sense of common cause.

共同困難令員工產生為共同目標並肩努力的感覺。

MCQ-ready definition:

common cause = 多人共同支持並為之努力的一項事業或目標

B. COMMON GROUND

10. common ground — 共同點; 共識基礎

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

The two sides need to find **common ground**.

雙方需要尋找共同點／共識基礎。

Practice 2

Despite their differences, they found some common ground.

儘管彼此有分歧，他們仍找到一些共識。

MCQ-ready definition:

common ground = 不同的人都能同意的觀點、利益或原則

11. find common ground — 尋找共識

Practice 1

Conflict resolution often begins by **finding common ground**.

衝突化解往往從尋找共同點開始。

Practice 2

The managers found common ground on safety.

管理人員在安全問題上找到共識。

12. areas of common ground — 有共識的範疇

Practice 1

Focus first on **areas of common ground**.

首先集中在大家已有共識的範疇。

Practice 2

Common ground can make later negotiation easier.

共同基礎可以令之後的談判更容易。

C. COMMON BOND / IDENTITY / EXPERIENCE

13. common bond — 共同聯繫; 共同紐帶

Practice 1

Shared experience created a **common bond**.

共同經歷建立了一種共同紐帶。

Practice 2

Team members developed a common bond through the project.

團隊成員透過項目建立了共同連結。

14. common identity — 共同身份認同

Practice 1

Strong teams often develop a **common identity**.

強大的團隊往往會形成共同身份認同。

Practice 2

A common identity can coexist with individual differences.

共同身份認同可以與個人差異同時存在。

15. common experience — 共同經歷

Practice 1

The crisis became a **common experience** for the whole organisation.

這場危機成為整個機構的共同經歷。

Practice 2

Common experiences can strengthen relationships.

共同經歷可以加強關係。

16. common background — 共同背景

Practice 1

They discovered they had a **common background**.

他們發現彼此有相似／共同背景。

Practice 2

A common background is not necessary for good teamwork.

良好團隊合作並不要求所有人都有共同背景。

17. common history — 共同歷史

Practice 1

The two communities share a **common history**.

兩個社群有一段共同歷史。

Practice 2

Common history can shape group identity.

共同歷史可以塑造群體認同。

18. common heritage — 共同文化遺產

Practice 1

The project celebrates the region's **common heritage**.

項目慶祝該地區的共同文化遺產。

Practice 2

Different groups may still share a common heritage.

不同群體仍可能有共同傳承。

D. COMMON LANGUAGE

19. common language = language shared by people — 共同語言

Practice 1

The teams need a **common language** for discussing risk.

團隊需要一套討論風險的共同語言。

Practice 2

English served as a common language.

英語成為大家的共通語言。

20. common language = shared terminology/concepts — 共通表達方式

Figurative extension.

Practice 1

The departments developed a **common language for performance measurement**.

各部門建立了一套衡量績效的共通術語。

Practice 2

A common language reduces misunderstanding between specialists.

一套共通表達方式可以減少不同專業人士之間的誤會。

This is especially relevant to your earlier:

different **professional language**

Teams may need to develop a **common language** across departments.

E. HAVE SOMETHING IN COMMON

21. have something in common — 有共同之處

A major expression.

Practice 1

The two teams **have a lot in common**.

兩個團隊有很多共同之處。

Practice 2

What do these examples have in common?

這些例子有甚麼共同點？

MCQ-ready definition:

have X in common = 共同擁有某項特質、興趣、經歷等

22. have a lot in common — 有很多共同點

Practice 1

They seem different, but they **have a lot in common**.

他們看似不同，其實有很多共同點。

Practice 2

Effective leaders often have certain qualities in common.

有效領導者往往有某些共同特質。

23. have little in common — 沒有太多共同點

Practice 1

The two colleagues **have little in common** outside work.

兩名同事在工作以外沒有太多共同點。

Practice 2

Their approaches have little in common.

他們的方法幾乎沒有共同之處。

24. have nothing in common — 毫無共同點

Practice 1

They thought they had **nothing in common**.

他們原本以為彼此毫無共同點。

Practice 2

The two methods have almost nothing in common.

兩種方法幾乎完全不同。

25. in common with — 與……一樣／與……共有

Practice 1

In common with many large organisations, the company uses several reporting systems.

與很多大型機構一樣，這家公司使用多套匯報系統。

Practice 2

She has several qualities in common with her predecessor.

她與前任有數項共同特質。

F. COMMONALITY

26. commonality = shared feature or quality — 共同點；共通性

Practice 1

The researchers looked for **commonalities** between successful teams.

研究人員尋找成功團隊之間的共同點。

Practice 2

Despite cultural differences, there are important commonalities.

儘管文化不同，彼此仍有重要共通點。

MCQ-ready definition:

commonality = 兩個或以上的人／事物共同具備的特點

27. commonality between/among —之間的共同點

Practice 1

There is considerable **commonality** between the two approaches.

兩種方法之間有相當多共通之處。

Practice 2

The study identified commonalities among the groups.

研究找出了不同群體之間共同點。

G. COMMON = FREQUENT / WIDESPREAD

28. common = happening or found often — 常見的; 普遍的

A second major adjective branch.

Practice 1

Communication problems are **common** in large teams.

溝通問題在大型團隊中很常見。

Practice 2

This is a common mistake among learners.

這是學習者很常犯的錯誤。

Practice 3

Headaches are a common symptom.

頭痛是一種常見症狀。

MCQ-ready definition:

common = 經常出現、很多人／地方都有的

29. common problem — 常見問題

Practice 1

Free-riding is a **common problem** in poorly structured group work.

搭便車是結構欠佳的團隊工作中一個常見問題。

Practice 2

Delayed communication is a common problem.

溝通延誤是一個常見問題。

30. common mistake — 常見錯誤

Practice 1

This is a **common mistake**.

這是一個常見錯誤。

Practice 2

A common mistake is to confuse “common” with “ordinary” in every context.

一個常見錯誤是把所有 **common** 都理解成「普通」。

31. common occurrence — 常見現象／常發生的事情

Practice 1

Delays became a **common occurrence**.

延誤變成了常見現象。

Practice 2

Remote meetings are now a common occurrence in many workplaces.

遙距會議在很多工作環境中已成為常見事情。

32. common practice — 常見做法; 慣常做法

Practice 1

It is **common practice** to send a written summary after the meeting.

會議後發送書面摘要是常見做法。

Practice 2

Regular progress checks are common practice in many projects.

定期進度檢查在很多項目中都是慣常做法。

MCQ-ready definition:

common practice = 很多人／機構經常採用的做法

33. common feature — 常見特點

Practice 1

Shared calendars are a **common feature** of project-management systems.

共用日曆是項目管理系統的常見功能。

Practice 2

Unequal participation is a common feature of badly managed group work.

參與不均和管理欠佳團隊工作的常見特點。

34. common symptom — 常見症狀

Practice 1

Fatigue is a **common symptom**.

疲勞是一種常見症狀。

Practice 2

Different conditions can share common symptoms.

不同病況可以有一些共同／常見症狀。

Again context can activate:

- shared,
 - frequent.
-

H. COMMON AMONG / IN / TO

35. common among a group — 在某群體中常見

Practice 1

This attitude is **common among new employees**.

這種態度在新員工中很常見。

Practice 2

The problem is common among small businesses.

這個問題在小型企業中很普遍。

36. common in a place/field — 在某地方／領域常見

Practice 1

Flexible working is increasingly **common in professional services**.

彈性工作在專業服務行業中愈來愈普遍。

Practice 2

This structure is common in large organisations.

這種架構在大型機構中很常見。

37. common to several things — 幾者共同具有

Important grammar shift.

Practice 1

What features are **common to successful teams**?

成功團隊有哪些共同特點？

Practice 2

Trust is a feature common to most healthy working relationships.

信任是大多數健康工作關係都共同具備的特點。

MCQ-ready definition:

common to A and B = A 和 B 都具有的

Compare:

common **among employees** = 員工中很常見

common **to both teams** = 兩隊都共有

I. COMMONLY

38. **commonly** = often; by many people — 通常; 普遍地; 常見地

Practice 1

The term is **commonly used** in business.

這個詞在商業中常用。

Practice 2

This problem commonly occurs in large groups.

這個問題在大型群體中經常出現。

39. **commonly used** — 常用的

Practice 1

Email is still a **commonly used communication channel**.

電郵仍是一種常用的溝通渠道。

Practice 2

These expressions are commonly used in formal writing.

這些表達在正式寫作中很常見。

40. commonly known as — 通常稱為; 俗稱

Practice 1

The condition is **commonly known as** the common cold.

這種病況通常稱為普通感冒。

Practice 2

The organisation is commonly known by its abbreviation.

該機構通常以其縮寫名稱為人所知。

41. commonly found — 常見於

Practice 1

The species is commonly found in coastal areas.

這個物種常見於沿岸地區。

Practice 2

This error is commonly found in first drafts.

這個錯誤在初稿中經常出現。

J. COMMON = ORDINARY / NOT SPECIAL

42. common = ordinary; not rare or special — 普通的; 平凡的

A third major branch.

Practice 1

The material was once expensive but is now quite **common**.

這種材料以前昂貴，現在卻十分普通／普及。

Practice 2

It was an ordinary, common household object.

那是一件很普通的家居物品。

MCQ-ready definition:

common = 並不特別、罕見或高級的

43. common object/item — 普通物件

Practice 1

The museum displayed several **common household objects** from the period.

博物館展示了當時數件普通家居物品。

Practice 2

Even common objects can have historical value.

即使是普通物件也可以有歷史價值。

44. common variety/type — 普通品種／常見類型

Practice 1

This is the most **common variety**.

這是最常見／普通的品種。

Practice 2

The common variety is cheaper than the rare one.

普通品種比稀有品種便宜。

Here **common** can combine:

- frequency,
 - lack of rarity.
-

K. COMMONPLACE

45. commonplace = ordinary and not unusual — 平常的；司空見慣的

Practice 1

Video meetings have become **commonplace**.

視像會議已變得司空見慣。

Practice 2

What once seemed unusual is now commonplace.

以前看來不尋常的事現在已經十分平常。

MCQ-ready definition:

commonplace = 因為非常普遍而不再令人覺得特別或驚訝的

46. a commonplace = ordinary fact/remark — 平常事；老生常談

Practice 1

It is now a **commonplace** that technology changes working habits.

科技改變工作習慣如今已是老生常談／普遍認知。

Practice 2

The observation may sound like a commonplace, but it remains important.

這個觀察可能聽起來像老生常談，但仍然重要。

47. become commonplace — 變得普遍／司空見慣

Practice 1

Hybrid meetings have become commonplace.

混合式會議已變得十分普遍。

Practice 2

Practices once limited to large companies are becoming commonplace.

以前只見於大型公司的做法正變得很普遍。

L. COMMON-OR-GARDEN

48. common-or-garden = very ordinary — 極普通的; 平平無奇的

Especially BrE, informal.

Practice 1

It's just a **common-or-garden** office chair.

那只是一張普通得不能再普通的辦公椅。

Practice 2

The device uses common-or-garden components.

裝置使用一般普通零件。

MCQ-ready definition:

common-or-garden = BrE informal: 非常普通、毫不特別的

AmE has the comparable expression:

garden-variety

M. COMMON = LOWER-CLASS / VULGAR

49. common = vulgar, lacking refinement — 粗俗的; 沒教養的

A modern but **class-sensitive and disapproving**, especially BrE, sense.

Practice 1

Calling someone's accent “**common**” can sound classist and insulting.

把某人的口音形容為 **common**, 可能帶有階級偏見和侮辱意味。

Practice 2

The character is portrayed as loud and common.

這個角色被描寫成吵鬧而粗俗沒教養。

MCQ-ready definition:

common = disapproving, especially BrE: 被視為缺乏教養、品味或社會地位的

Learners should **recognise this sense but use it very carefully**.

50. sound/look common — 顯得粗俗／低俗

Practice 1

That expression may sound common in very traditional class-conscious usage.

在某些傳統、階級色彩較強的語境中，那種表達可能被形容為粗俗。

Practice 2

“Common” used about people is often judgmental.

用 **common** 形容人通常帶有貶義判斷。

N. COMMON PEOPLE / COMMONER

51. common people = ordinary members of society — 普通人；平民

Historically common, but modern tone depends on context.

Practice 1

The phrase **common people** traditionally means ordinary people rather than elites.

common people 傳統上指一般平民／普通大眾。

Practice 2

In modern everyday English, “ordinary people” is often more neutral.

在現代日常英語中，**ordinary people** 往往語氣更中性。

52. **commoner** = person without noble rank — 平民；非貴族人士

Practice 1

Historically, **commoner** distinguished ordinary people from the nobility.

歷史上，**commoner** 用來區分平民與貴族。

Practice 2

The term still appears in historical and institutional contexts.

這個詞今天仍會出現在歷史和制度語境中。

MCQ-ready definition:

commoner = 不屬於貴族階級的人

O. COMMON KNOWLEDGE

53. **common knowledge** — 常識；眾所周知的事

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

It is **common knowledge** that the team is understaffed.

團隊人手不足已是眾所周知的事。

Practice 2

The information was already common knowledge.

這項資訊早已人盡皆知。

MCQ-ready definition:

common knowledge = 很多人已經知道、一般不需要特別證明的事情

54. be common knowledge — 眾所周知

Practice 1

The problem is now **common knowledge**.

這個問題現在已經眾所周知。

Practice 2

It became common knowledge within the company.

這件事在公司內逐漸變得人盡皆知。

Important distinction: common knowledge vs common sense

These are completely different.

common knowledge

很多人都知道的資訊。

common sense

基本合理判斷能力。

P. COMMON SENSE

55. common sense — 常識; 基本判斷力

One of the most important compounds.

Practice 1

Use **common sense**.

要有點常識／基本判斷力。

Practice 2

Good procedures should support, not replace, common sense.

良好程序應支援而不是取代人的基本判斷力。

MCQ-ready definition:

common sense = 一般人處理日常實際問題時應有的合理判斷能力

56. common-sense approach — 符合常理的做法

Practice 1

We need a **common-sense approach**.

我們需要一個合乎常理的做法。

Practice 2

A common-sense solution may be better than an unnecessarily complicated one.

一個合常理的解決方法可能比過分複雜的方法更好。

57. use common sense — 運用常識

Practice 1

Rules cannot cover every situation, so staff must **use common sense**.

規則不能涵蓋所有情況，所以員工必須運用基本判斷力。

Practice 2

Use common sense when handling confidential information.

處理機密資料時要運用常識和判斷力。

Q. COMMON COURTESY / DECENCY

58. common courtesy — 基本禮貌

Practice 1

Replying to the message is **common courtesy**.

回覆訊息是基本禮貌。

Practice 2

It is common courtesy to let people know if you will be late.

如果會遲到，通知別人是基本禮儀。

59. common decency — 基本道德／基本人情

Practice 1

Common decency requires treating colleagues with respect.

基本做人道理／基本禮義要求我們尊重同事。

Practice 2

He appealed to their sense of common decency.

他呼籲大家基於基本良知行事。

MCQ-ready definition:

common decency = 一般人應有的最低限度尊重、體諒和道德行為

R. COMMON GOOD

60. the common good — 公共利益；共同福祉

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

Individuals sometimes need to cooperate for **the common good**.

個人有時需要為了共同利益／公共福祉而合作。

Practice 2

Good teamwork requires people to look beyond personal pride towards the common good.

良好團隊合作要求人們超越個人自尊，着眼於共同利益。

MCQ-ready definition:

the common good = 對整個群體或社會都有益的結果

61. for the common good — 為了共同利益

Practice 1

They accepted the compromise **for the common good**.

他們為了整體利益接受妥協。

Practice 2

Resources should be used responsibly for the common good.

資源應負責任地用於公共利益。

S. COMMON OWNERSHIP / PROPERTY

62. common ownership — 共同所有權

Practice 1

The land is under **common ownership**.

這幅土地屬於共同所有。

Practice 2

Common ownership means more than one party shares ownership rights.

共同所有權表示多於一方共同擁有相關權利。

63. common property — 共有財產；共同資源

Practice 1

The courtyard is **common property** shared by residents.

庭院是居民共同擁有的共有地方／共有財產。

Practice 2

Certain resources may be treated as common property.

某些資源可被視為共有資源。

64. common resources — 共有資源

Practice 1

Teams need rules for using **common resources**.

團隊需要制定使用共有資源的規則。

Practice 2

Shared facilities are common resources.

共用設施屬於共同資源。

T. COMMON AREA / COMMON ROOM

65. common area — 公用區域

Practice 1

Employees can eat in the **common area**.

員工可以在公用區域用餐。

Practice 2

Residents share several common areas.

住戶共用數個公用地方。

MCQ-ready definition:

common area = 由多名使用者共同使用、不屬於單一個人的空間

66. common room — 公共休息室; 共用休息室

Especially BrE/institutional.

Practice 1

Staff were meeting in the **common room**.

員工正在公共休息室開會。

Practice 2

Students can relax in the common room.

學生可以在共用休息室休息。

U. COMMON LAND / THE COMMONS

67. common land — 公共／共有土地

Practice 1

Local people traditionally had certain rights over the **common land**.

當地居民傳統上對這些共有土地享有某些使用權。

Practice 2

The path crosses an area of common land.

小徑穿過一片公共共有土地。

68. the commons = resources shared by a community — 公共共有資源

A major economics/environmental concept.

Practice 1

Fisheries can be discussed as part of **the commons**.

漁業資源可以放在公共共有資源的框架下討論。

Practice 2

Managing the commons requires rules for shared use.

管理公共資源需要制定共同使用規則。

69. tragedy of the commons — 公地悲劇

A major economics/environmental expression.

Practice 1

Overuse of a shared resource can illustrate the **tragedy of the commons**.

過度使用共享資源可以說明公地悲劇。

Practice 2

The tragedy of the commons describes a situation in which individually rational use can collectively exhaust a shared resource.

公地悲劇描述個人為自身利益使用公共資源，最後卻令共享資源被過度耗用的情況。

MCQ-ready definition:

tragedy of the commons = 個別使用者各自追求利益，結果令共同資源被過度使用或破壞的問題

V. COMMON NOUN — GRAMMAR

70. common noun — 普通名詞

A major grammar term.

Practice 1

Teacher is a **common noun**.

teacher 是一個普通名詞。

Practice 2

Common nouns normally do not begin with a capital letter unless another rule requires it.

普通名詞一般不會因為本身是名詞而使用大寫字母。

MCQ-ready definition:

common noun = 指某一類人、地方、事物或概念，而不是特定專名的名詞

71. common noun vs proper noun — 普通名詞 vs 專有名詞

city = common noun
Hong Kong = proper noun

teacher = common noun
Ms Chan = proper name

So:

common noun = 類別名稱

proper noun = 特定個體名稱

72. common gender — 通性

A grammar term used in some grammatical traditions.

Practice 1

Some grammar descriptions use the term **common gender**.

某些文法系統會使用 **common gender**(通性) 這個術語。

Practice 2

The precise meaning depends on the grammatical system being described.

實際意思取決於所描述的語言和文法體系。

W. MATHEMATICS: COMMON FACTOR

73. common factor — 公因數

Practice 1

3 is a **common factor** of 6 and 9.

3 是 6 和 9 的公因數。

Practice 2

Find the common factors of the two numbers.

找出兩個數的公因數。

MCQ-ready definition:

common factor = 能夠整除兩個或以上數字的同一個因數

74. greatest common factor / greatest common divisor — 最大公因數

Practice 1

The **greatest common factor** of 12 and 18 is 6.

12 和 18 的最大公因數是 6。

Practice 2

“Greatest common divisor” is another common term.

greatest common divisor 也是常用術語，意為最大公因數。

75. common multiple — 公倍數

Practice 1

12 is a **common multiple** of 3 and 4.

12 是 3 和 4 的公倍數。

Practice 2

Find a common multiple of 6 and 8.

找出 6 和 8 的一個公倍數。

76. least common multiple — 最小公倍數

Practice 1

The **least common multiple** of 4 and 6 is 12.

4 和 6 的最小公倍數是 12。

Practice 2

LCM stands for least common multiple.

LCM 是 **least common multiple** (最小公倍數) 的縮寫。

X. COMMON DENOMINATOR

77. common denominator — 公分母

Literal mathematical sense.

Practice 1

Rewrite the fractions with a **common denominator**.

把分數改寫成具有公分母的形式。

Practice 2

Six can be used as a common denominator for these fractions.

6 可以作為這些分數的公分母。

78. common denominator = shared feature — 共同點

A major figurative extension.

Practice 1

Poor communication was the **common denominator** in all three failures.

溝通不良是三次失敗的共同因素。

Practice 2

Trust is a common denominator among successful teams.

信任是成功團隊的一個共同特點。

MCQ-ready definition:

common denominator = 多個不同情況都共同具有的因素

79. lowest common denominator — 最低公分母；最低共同水平

Literal math sense exists, but the figurative sense is especially common.

Figurative Practice

The programme was criticised for appealing to the **lowest common denominator**.

這個節目被批評為迎合最低層次的共同品味。

MCQ-ready definition:

lowest common denominator = figurative: 為了迎合最多人而採用的最低共同標準或最基本趣味

Often negative.

Y. COMMON FRACTION / RATIO / LOGARITHM

80. common fraction — 普通分數

Practice 1

$\frac{3}{4}$ is a **common fraction**.

$\frac{3}{4}$ 是一個普通分數。

Practice 2

Common fractions can be written as one integer over another.

普通分數可用一個整數除以另一個整數表示。

81. common ratio — 公比

A sequence term.

Practice 1

The sequence has a **common ratio** of 2.

這個數列的公比是 2。

Practice 2

In a geometric sequence, consecutive terms have a constant common ratio.

等比數列相鄰項之間具有固定公比。

82. common logarithm — 常用對數

Practice 1

A **common logarithm** usually means a logarithm to base 10.

常用對數通常指以 10 為底的對數。

Practice 2

Common logarithms were historically useful in manual calculation.

常用對數過去常用於手工計算。

Z. BUSINESS: COMMON STOCK / COMMON SHARES

83. common stock — 普通股

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

The company issued **common stock**.

公司發行了普通股。

Practice 2

Common stock represents an ownership interest in a company.

普通股代表公司的股權權益。

MCQ-ready definition:

common stock = 公司最一般的股權類別之一，與優先股等其他類別區分

84. common shares — 普通股

Very common internationally.

Practice 1

Investors purchased **common shares**.

投資者購入普通股。

Practice 2

Common shareholders may receive dividends if declared.

普通股股東在公司宣布派息時可能獲得股息。

85. common shareholder — 普通股股東

Practice 1

Common shareholders usually have rights attached to their shares.

普通股股東享有股份所附帶的相關權利。

Practice 2

The exact rights depend on the company's share structure.

實際權利取決於公司的股份架構。

AA. COMMON MARKET

86. common market — 共同市場

An economics/business term.

Practice 1

A **common market** allows closer economic integration among participating economies.

共同市場涉及參與經濟體之間較深入的經濟整合。

Practice 2

The term is more specific than simply “a market shared by several companies.”

common market 是特定經濟概念，不只是「多人共同使用的市場」。

MCQ-ready definition:

common market = 多個經濟體在貨物、服務及通常某些生產要素流動方面高度整合的市場安排

AB. COMMON LAW

87. common law — 普通法

A major legal compound.

Practice 1

The case concerns a principle of **common law**.

案件涉及一項普通法原則。

Practice 2

“Common law” is a fixed legal term and should not be translated word-for-word as “共同法律.”

common law 是固定法律術語，應譯作普通法。

MCQ-ready definition:

common law = 以司法判例和歷史法律傳統發展出的法律體系／法律原則之一

88. common-law system — 普通法制度

Practice 1

The course compares common-law and civil-law traditions.

課程比較普通法與大陸法系傳統。

Practice 2

Legal terminology differs between systems.

不同法律制度使用的術語不同。

89. common-law partner / marriage — 普通法伴侶／事實婚姻相關用語

An established expression whose legal meaning varies greatly by jurisdiction.

Practice 1

The phrase **common-law partner** is used differently in different legal systems.

common-law partner 在不同司法制度中的法律含義有所不同。

Practice 2

Do not assume “common-law marriage” has the same legal effect everywhere.

不要假設 **common-law marriage** 在所有地方都有相同法律效力。

For learners:

treat this as a fixed legal/social expression, not as the ordinary “common = shared” meaning.

AC. THE COMMONS

90. the Commons — 下議院等制度性專名中的 Commons

Capitalized institutional use.

Practice 1

Commons appears in established institutional names such as **House of Commons**.

Commons 會出現在 **House of Commons** (下議院) 等固定制度名稱中。

Practice 2

This meaning is lexicalized and should not be confused with ordinary “common.”

這個用法已經詞彙化，不應與一般的 **common** = 常見／共同 混淆。

AD. COMMON NAME

91. common name = everyday non-scientific name — 俗名；普通名稱

Practice 1

A species may have both a scientific name and a **common name**.

一個物種可以同時有學名和俗名。

Practice 2

Common names can vary between regions.

俗名可能因地區不同而有所差異。

MCQ-ready definition:

common name = 日常使用、非正式科學分類名稱的名稱

92. common name = name shared by many people — 常見名字

A different sense.

Practice 1

Chan is a very **common surname** in some Chinese communities.

在某些華人社群中，Chan 是一個很常見的姓氏。

Practice 2

It is a common first name.

這是一個很常見的名字。

AE. COMMON TOUCH

93. the common touch — 與普通人親近、容易相處的能力

A fixed expression.

Practice 1

Despite his senior position, he has **the common touch**.

儘管職位很高，他仍然很懂得與普通人打成一片。

Practice 2

A leader with the common touch can communicate naturally with many kinds of people.

有 **the common touch** 的領導者能自然地與不同背景的人溝通。

MCQ-ready definition:

the common touch = 與一般人自然相處、令普通人感到親切的能力

AF. UNCOMMON

94. uncommon = not often seen or found — 不常見的; 罕見的

The most important opposite of frequency **common**.

Practice 1

That reaction is **uncommon**.

那種反應不常見。

Practice 2

It is not uncommon for teams to disagree.

團隊出現分歧並不罕見。

95. not uncommon — 並不少見

A very common understated expression.

Practice 1

It is **not uncommon** for projects to change direction.

項目改變方向並不少見。

Practice 2

Such misunderstandings are not uncommon.

這類誤會頗為常見。

Notice:

not uncommon

often means:

fairly common

rather than merely “possible.”

96. uncommon = unusually great/remarkable — 非凡的; 異常出色的

A separate positive branch.

Practice 1

She showed **uncommon courage**.

她表現出非凡的勇氣。

Practice 2

He has uncommon patience.

他有異乎尋常的耐性。

MCQ-ready definition:

uncommon = 超出一般水平、不尋常地突出

97. uncommonly = unusually — 異常地; 格外地

Practice 1

She was **uncommonly calm** under pressure.

她在壓力下異常冷靜。

Practice 2

The solution is uncommonly effective.

這個方案格外有效。

AG. COMMONNESS

98. commonness = frequency or ordinary quality — 普遍性; 平凡性

Less common than simply saying:

how common something is.

Practice 1

The **commonness** of the error suggests a problem in the instructions.

這個錯誤的普遍性顯示指示可能有問題。

Practice 2

In everyday English, “how common it is” is usually more natural than “its commonness.”

在日常英語中，通常說 **how common it is** 會比 **its commonness** 更自然。

AH. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

Important distinction 1: common = shared vs common = frequent

This is the single most important polysemy distinction.

Shared:

a common goal
共同目標

Frequent:

a common mistake
常見錯誤

Same adjective, different relationship.

Important distinction 2: common purpose vs common problem

In your passage:

common purpose
= everyone shares the same purpose.

But:

a common problem
can mean:

1. a problem many people share, or
2. a frequently occurring problem.

Context matters.

Important distinction 3: common vs shared

shared

explicitly emphasizes multiple people possessing the same thing.

common

can mean shared, but has many other senses.

shared objective
common objective

are very close.

Shared makes the “everyone has it together” idea slightly more explicit.

Important distinction 4: common vs mutual

common

several people share the same thing.

mutual

typically two or more parties feel/do something **towards each other**.

Compare:

common goal
共同目標

mutual respect
互相尊重

Usually:

mutual goal
is possible in some contexts but **common/shared goal** is much more natural.

Important distinction 5: common vs collective

common

shared by members.

collective

belonging to or done by the group considered as one whole.

common interest
共同利益

collective responsibility
集體責任

They overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction 6: common vs communal

common

shared in a broad sense.

communal

shared/used by a community, often physically.

common goal

共同目標

communal kitchen

共用廚房

Do not normally say:

communal purpose

for the passage meaning.

Important distinction 7: common vs public

common

shared by a defined group/community.

public

available to or concerning the public generally.

common area in an apartment building

住戶共用區域

public park

公眾公園

A common area is not necessarily open to the general public.

Important distinction 8: common vs ordinary

common

may mean frequent.

ordinary

not special/unusual.

Example:

a common disease
常見疾病

does **not** mean:

an ordinary/unimportant disease.

So:

common ≠ ordinary in every sentence.

Important distinction 9: common vs usual

common

occurs frequently across many instances.

usual

what normally happens for a particular person/situation.

a common mistake among learners
學習者常犯錯誤

my usual mistake
我通常會犯的錯誤／我慣常犯的錯

Different reference.

Important distinction 10: common vs typical

common

frequent.

typical

representative/characteristic of a type.

A feature can be:

typical but not extremely common,

or:

common but not especially defining.

Important distinction 11: common vs popular

common

frequent/widespread.

popular

liked or chosen by many people.

common problem
常見問題

popular product
受歡迎產品

A problem can be common without being popular.

Important distinction 12: common vs prevalent

prevalent

formal and means widespread/common, especially:

- condition,
- practice,
- attitude,
- disease.

common

more general and everyday.

common problem
prevalent problem

The second sounds more formal.

Important distinction 13: common vs widespread

common

many occurrences.

widespread

spread across a large area/group.

common typo
常見錯字

widespread unemployment
廣泛失業問題

Something can be common within one small group but not widespread geographically.

Important distinction 14: commonplace vs common

common

frequent.

commonplace

so ordinary/frequent that it no longer seems remarkable.

online meetings are common
常見

online meetings are commonplace
已經司空見慣

Commonplace is stronger.

Important distinction 15: common vs commonplace noun

common = adjective in most ordinary uses.

commonplace = adjective **or noun**.

Example:

Such remarks are commonplace.
這些說法很平常。

It has become a commonplace.
這已成為老生常談。

Important distinction 16: common vs vulgar/uncultured

The negative social-class sense:

“He's common.”

does **not** mean:

“He is frequent.”

It means roughly:

被說話者視為「粗俗、沒教養、缺乏品味」

This can be insulting and class-loaded.

Use cautiously.

Important distinction 17: commoner vs ordinary person

commoner

historically/institutionally contrasts with nobility.

ordinary person

neutral everyday expression.

So for normal modern conversation:

ordinary people

is usually safer and more natural.

Important distinction 18: common knowledge vs general knowledge

common knowledge

a fact almost everyone already knows.

general knowledge

broad knowledge across many subjects.

It's common knowledge that...
眾所周知.....

general knowledge quiz
常識問答比賽

Not synonyms.

Important distinction 19: common sense vs knowledge

knowledge

information you know.

common sense

practical judgment about ordinary situations.

A highly knowledgeable person can still show poor common sense.

Important distinction 20: common sense vs good judgment

Very close, but:

common sense

everyday practical reasoning.

good judgment

broader ability to make sound decisions, including complex professional contexts.

Important distinction 21: common courtesy vs common practice

common courtesy

what basic politeness requires.

common practice

what people commonly do.

Something may be common practice without being courteous.

Important distinction 22: common good vs common interest

common interest

benefit/concern shared by specific parties.

common good

welfare of the broader group as a whole.

In teamwork:

individual interest
vs
common good of the team.

Important distinction 23: common property vs public property

common property

shared ownership/use by a group.

public property

owned/controlled by a public authority or public body.

Not automatically the same.

Important distinction 24: common area vs public area

common area

shared by residents/members/users.

public area

open to the general public.

An apartment lobby can be:

common area

without being:

public area.

Important distinction 25: common land vs public park

Common land is a specific historical/legal land concept in some places.

It is not simply another word for:

public park.

Important distinction 26: the commons vs common land

common land

actual land subject to shared/common use rights.

the commons

broader concept of shared resources, which can include:

- land,
 - fisheries,
 - atmosphere,
 - shared knowledge/resources in some contexts.
-

Important distinction 27: common noun vs ordinary noun

The established grammar term is:

common noun

not:

ordinary noun

as the standard opposite of **proper noun**.

Important distinction 28: common denominator literal vs figurative

Math:

common denominator

公分母

Figurative:

a common denominator among successful teams

共同因素／共同特點

Same metaphor:

different things share one underlying element.

Important distinction 29: lowest common denominator

Figuratively, this often carries a **negative** implication:

lowest shared level that appeals to everyone.

It may suggest:

- oversimplification,
- low standards,
- crude taste.

Do not confuse with neutral:

common denominator.

Important distinction 30: common factor vs common feature

common factor

may mean:

- mathematical 公因數,
- or shared causal/underlying factor.

common feature

shared characteristic.

Example:

stress was a common factor in all cases
壓力是共同因素

honesty was a common feature of the teams
誠實是共同特點

Important distinction 31: common stock vs stock that is common

Common stock is a lexicalized finance term:

普通股

It does not mean:

stock that is frequently seen.

Important distinction 32: common law

Again, lexicalized:

common law = 普通法

It is not composed semantically as:

“law shared by everyone.”

Treat it as a fixed term.

Important distinction 33: common name

Two major readings:

Biology:

common name
俗名

Frequency:

common name/surname
常見名字／姓氏

Context decides.

Important distinction 34: common language in your passage world

The passage earlier says departments may use different:

professional language

A useful solution is to develop:

a common language

This does not mean everyone must stop using technical vocabulary.

It means:

they establish shared terms and definitions across departments.

Important distinction 35: common purpose vs identical personality

This is central to your passage.

The writer does **not** argue that team members should become similar.

Rather:

different personalities

- common purpose
= productive diversity.

So:

common = shared objective

not:

everyone becoming the same

Important distinction 36: common purpose vs common approach

Two teams may have:

a common purpose

but different:

approaches.

Example:

common purpose = successful launch

product approach = speed

compliance approach = caution

This echoes the passage's earlier conflict.

Important distinction 37: common purpose vs common priority

purpose

why the group exists / what final outcome it serves.

priority

what receives greatest immediate importance.

Teams can have:

one common purpose

while holding:

different immediate priorities.

Important distinction 38: common purpose vs shared objective

Very close.

common purpose

often broader and more motivating:

why are we doing this?

shared objective

often more concrete:

what exactly are we trying to achieve?

Example:

common purpose = provide safe, useful products

shared objective = launch Product X successfully by December

Important distinction 39: common in your passage

The full sentence is:

Group work is most effective when contribution is transparent, communication is disciplined and leadership is strong enough to unite different personalities around a **common purpose**.

Here **common** cannot mean:

- frequent,
- ordinary,
- vulgar,
- public,
- mathematically shared.

It specifically means:

shared by all team members

The writer's logic is:

different personalities

- different working styles

- possibly different departmental priorities
but
one common purpose

That shared purpose prevents diversity from turning into:

division.

Family-extension note

The **common** family has several major modern branches:

1. shared

- common purpose
- common goal
- common interest

2. agreement/commonality

- common ground
- common bond
- commonality

3. shared language/identity

- common language
- common identity

4. have in common

- a lot in common
- nothing in common

5. frequent/widespread

- common mistake
- common problem
- common symptom

6. ordinary/not rare

- common object
- common variety

7. very ordinary

- commonplace
- common-or-garden

8. class-sensitive negative

- common = vulgar/uncultured

9. ordinary people

- commoner
- common people

10. widely known

- common knowledge

11. practical judgment

- common sense

12. basic social standards

- common courtesy
- common decency

13. shared welfare

- common good

14. shared ownership/resources

- common property
- the commons

15. shared space

- common area
- common room

16. grammar

- common noun
- common gender

17. mathematics

- common factor
- common multiple
- common denominator
- common ratio
- common logarithm

18. finance

- common stock
- common shares

19. economics

- common market

20. law

- common law
- common-law

21. names

- common name

22. social ability

- the common touch

23. opposite family

- uncommon
- uncommonly

For your passage, the exact branch is:

common = shared by everyone in the team, despite their individual differences

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
common (shared)	共同的; 共有的	passage sense
common purpose	共同目的	team unity
common goal	共同目標	shared aim
common objective	共同目標	shared target
common interest	共同興趣／利益	shared interest
common concern	共同關注	shared concern
common enemy	共同敵人	shared opposition
common cause	共同事業	shared cause
common ground	共同點; 共識	agreement
find common ground	尋找共識	reconciliation
common bond	共同紐帶	relationship
common identity	共同身份認同	identity
common experience	共同經歷	shared experience
common history	共同歷史	history
common heritage	共同文化遺產	heritage
common language	共同／共通語言	communication
have X in common	有共同之處	similarity
have a lot in common	有很多共同點	similarity
have little in common	共同點很少	difference

nothing in common	毫無共同點	difference
in common with	與……一樣／共有	shared trait
commonality	共同點; 共通性	shared features
common (frequent)	常見的; 普遍的	frequency
common problem	常見問題	frequency
common mistake	常見錯誤	frequency
common occurrence	常見現象	frequency
common practice	常見／慣常做法	frequency
common feature	常見／共同特點	context-dependent
common symptom	常見症狀	frequency
common among X	在 X 中常見	frequency
common in X	在 X 中常見	frequency
common to A and B	A、B 共同具有	shared
commonly	通常; 普遍地	adverb
commonly used	常用的	frequency
commonly known as	通常稱為	naming
common (ordinary)	普通的; 平凡的	not special
commonplace	平常的; 司空見慣	very ordinary
a commonplace	平常事; 老生常談	noun
common-or-garden	極普通的	BrE informal
common (vulgar)	粗俗／沒教養的	disapproving
common people	普通人; 平民	social class

commoner	平民; 非貴族	social class
common knowledge	眾所周知	widely known
common sense	常識; 基本判斷力	practical judgment
common courtesy	基本禮貌	social norm
common decency	基本道德／良知	social norm
common good	公共利益; 共同福祉	group welfare
common ownership	共同所有權	ownership
common property	共有財產／資源	ownership
common resources	共同資源	shared resources
common area	公用區域	shared space
common room	公共休息室	shared space
common land	共有土地	land
the commons	公共共有資源	economics/environment
tragedy of the commons	公地悲劇	shared-resource problem
common noun	普通名詞	grammar
common gender	通性	grammar
common factor	公因數／共同因素	math/general
greatest common factor	最大公因數	mathematics
common multiple	公倍數	mathematics
least common multiple	最小公倍數	mathematics
common denominator	公分母／共同因素	math/figurative

lowest common denominator	最低公分母／最低共同標準	math/figurative
common fraction	普通分數	mathematics
common ratio	公比	mathematics
common logarithm	常用對數	mathematics
common stock	普通股	finance
common shares	普通股	finance
common market	共同市場	economics
common law	普通法	law
common-law	普通法的／特定伴侶法律用語	law
Commons	制度專名中的 Commons	institutional
common name	俗名／常見名字	biology/general
the common touch	與普通人打成一片的能力	social skill
uncommon	不常見的; 非凡的	opposite
not uncommon	並不少見	understated frequency
uncommonly	異常地; 格外地	adverb
commonness	普遍性; 平凡性	noun

For your original sentence

Group work is most effective when contribution is transparent, communication is disciplined and leadership is strong enough to unite different personalities around a **common purpose**.

Here:

common purpose = 儘管團隊成員的個性、工作方式和短期優先事項可能不同, 但大家都認同並共同追求同一個更高層次的目的

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

當每名成員的貢獻都清楚透明、溝通有紀律，而且領導層能把不同性格的人團結在一個共同目的／共同目標之下時，團隊合作才最有效。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

common purpose = 所有人共同認同的目的

shared objective = 大家共同追求、通常較具體的目標

common ground = 大家都能同意的部分

common interest = 大家共同關心／受益的事情

common good = 整體群體的共同福祉

common language = 大家都能理解和使用的共通表達方式

And the most important polysemy contrast is:

a common purpose = 共同目的

a common mistake = 常見錯誤

a common object = 普通物件

common knowledge = 眾所周知的事

common sense = 常識／基本判斷力

common land = 共有土地

common noun = 普通名詞

common stock = 普通股

common law = 普通法

So in your teamwork conclusion, **common** is doing something very precise: it does **not erase difference**. It provides the **shared destination that allows difference to remain useful rather than becoming division**.